NUTRIMO
AGRI SCIENCE

Soil Sampling & Testing Guide

Know your soil before you feed your crop

Why test your soil?

A soil test reveals nutrient levels, pH and salinity so you can apply only what your field needs — saving money and protecting soil health.

When to sample

- 2–4 weeks before sowing or planting, after the previous harvest.
- Avoid sampling right after fertilizer or manure application.
- Sample each field every 2–3 years; annually for intensive horticulture.

How to collect a representative sample

- Step 1: Divide the farm into uniform areas by soil colour, crop history and slope.
- Step 2: In each area, pick 10–15 spots in a zig-zag pattern. Avoid bunds, channels, trees and manure pits.
- Step 3: Clear surface litter and dig a V-shaped pit 15 cm deep (22–30 cm for orchards).
- Step 4: Slice a 2 cm thick layer from one side of the pit and collect it in a clean bucket.
- Step 5: Mix all sub-samples, spread on a clean sheet and reduce to about 500 g by quartering.
- Step 6: Air-dry in shade, pack in a clean cloth or plastic bag and label with name, field, crop and date.

Reading your soil report

Parameter	What it tells you	Typical action
pH	Acidity or alkalinity (ideal 6.5–7.5)	Lime for acidic soils; gypsum or organic matter for alkaline soils
EC	Soluble salts / salinity	Improve drainage; avoid salt-rich fertilizers if high
Organic carbon	Soil health and biological activity	Add compost, green manure, crop residues
N, P, K	Major nutrient availability	Adjust NPK dose from Low / Medium / High ratings

Zn, Fe, B, S	Secondary and micronutrient status	Apply specific nutrient if deficient

Nutrimo offers soil and leaf testing with personalised recommendations. Book a test through our Services page or call our helpline.